PABLO E. BALÁN

Tel Aviv University
School of Political Science
Naftali Building, Room 530
Tel Aviv-Yafo, Israel

Email: pbalan@tauex.tau.ac.il
Website: www.pablobalan.com
Phone (US): +1-617-899-9726
Phone (IL): +972-534-739-105

Academic Positions

Tel Aviv University, School of Political Science

2023 – Senior Lecturer (Assistant Professor).

2022 – Lecturer (Assistant Professor).

Education

Harvard University 2015 – 2021

Ph.D. in Political Science, Department of Government.

Fields: Comparative Politics, Political Methodology, Political Economy of Development.

Committee: Torben Iversen (chair), Horacio Larreguy, Nathan Nunn.

Universidad Torcuato Di Tella

2015 M.A., Political Science.

Universidad de San Andrés

2012 B.A., Political Science.

Affiliations

2022 – Research Affiliate, Stigler Center for the Study of the Economy and the State, The University of Chicago Booth School of Business.

2020 – 2021 Visiting Scholar, Penn Development Research Initiative, The University of Pennsylvania.

Publications

1. Ethnic Diversity and Cooperation After Disaster: Evidence from Hurricane Harvey (with Pablo M. Pinto and Agustín Vallejo). [Working Paper] [Chicago Stigler Center Working Paper] ***Accepted, Journal of Political Institutions and Political Economy***.

2. Property Rights and Social Institutions in Urban Africa: Experimental Evidence from a Land Formalization Program in the DRC (with Augustin Bergeron, Gabriel Tourek, and Jonathan Weigel). [Journal] [Paper] [Chicago Stigler Center Working Paper] [Pre-Analysis Plan] ***Comparative Political Studies***.

3. Family Ties as Corporate Power (with Juan Dodyk and Ignacio Puente). [Working Paper] [Chicago Stigler Center Working Paper] ***Journal of Politics*** **44(2)**.

4. Local Elites as State Capacity: How City Chiefs Use Local Information to Increase Tax Compliance in the D.R. Congo (with Augustin Bergeron, Gabriel Tourek, and Jonathan Weigel). ***American Economic Review* 112(3): 762-797, March 2022**. [Journal] [Paper] [Pre-Analysis Plan].

5. The Political Behavior of Family Firms: Evidence from Brazil (with Juan Dodyk and Ignacio Puente). ***World Development* 151, March 2022**. [Journal] [Paper].

6. Information Provision, Voter Coordination, and Electoral Accountability: Evidence from Mexican Social Networks (with Eric Arias, Horacio Larreguy, John Marshall, and Pablo Querubín). ***American Political Science Review* 113(2): 475-498, May 2019**. [Journal] [Paper].

Working Papers Under Review

1. Barriers to Formalization: Evidence from Six Randomized Experiments on Transaction Costs, Public Services, and Taxation in the Global South (with Ana de la O, Donald Green, Peter John and 22 other collaborators). [Working Paper] ***Under review***.

2. The Long-Term Careers of Political Brokers: Evidence from Mexico (with Tesalia Rizzo). [Working Paper] ***Under review***.

3. The Conservation Paradox: How Armed Groups and the State Shape Forest Governance and Conservation in Post-Conflict Colombia (with Heather Huntington and Juan Tellez). [Working Paper] ***Under review***.

4. The Mechanics of Workplace Mobilization: Evidence From Brazilian Listed Companies. ***Under review***.

Working Papers

1. A Judge in the Family: The Value of Kinship Ties Between Judges and Law Firms.

2. Who Secures Property Rights Under Contested Authority? (with Heather Huntington and Juan F. Tellez)

3. Narratives and Market Exchange in Developing Countries (with Juan Pedro Ronconi).

Books

La República Pendiente: Argentina y el Problema del Desarrollo Político. Buenos Aires, El Ateneo (with Federico Tiberti), 2014.

Research Grants

Strauss-Raya Center for Family Business Research, Tel Aviv University, 2024 ($\sim$ USD 8,400).
Humane Studies Fellowship, Institute for Humane Studies, 2018 – 2020 (total: USD 21,000).
Adam Smith and Don Lavoie Fellowships, Mercatus Center at George Mason University, 2017 – 2020 (total: USD 15,000).
C. Lowell Harriss Dissertation Fellowship, Lincoln Institute of Land Policy, 2021 (USD 10,000).
Weatherhead Center For International Affairs, GSA Research Grant, 2020 (USD 1,960).

Weatherhead Center For International Affairs, Pre-/Mid-Dissertation Grants, 2018 – 2020 (total: USD 11,000).

Institute for Quantitative Social Science, Graduate Research Award, 2018, (USD 1,500).

EGAP Metaketa II: Taxation. Project: The Origins of Tax Compliance and Accountable Government: A Randomized Field Experiment in the D.R. Congo (with Augustin Bergeron, Gabriel Tourek, and Jonathan Weigel), 2017 (USD 224,195).

Awards

2026 Margaret Levi Award for the Advancement of Comparative Methodology, APSA (awarded to the 124 PIs and members of steering committees of the Metaketa Initiative).

Alon Fellowship for Outstanding Researchers, Israeli Council for Higher Education, 2023. Program to support the integration of young scientists. Three years of salary paid by the Council + research funds (∼$45,000).

Honorable Mention, Ronald Coase Dissertation Award, Society for Institutional & Organizational Economics, 2023.

Samuel P. Huntington Doctoral Fellowship, Harvard University, 2021.

Weatherhead Center for International Affairs, Graduate Student Associate, 2020.

El Ateneo Publishing House National Award, 2014.

Conferences

2026 (includes scheduled): MPSA, World Bank Land Conference 2026, APSA, Stigler Fellows Research Conference (Chicago Booth).

2025: ASREC (Association for the Study of Religion, Economics, and Culture), EPSA Pre-conference on Culture, APSA, Markets & Society Conference.

2024 (includes scheduled): MPSA, World Bank Land Conference 2024, LSE-NYU 13th Annual Conference in Political Science and Political Economy, SIOE (Society for Institutional & Organizational Economics), Stigler Fellows Research Conference (Chicago Booth), MIT-TAU Conference on Solidarity in Times of Fracture.

2023: MPSA, Israeli Political Science Association annual Meeting, Israeli Economic Association Annual Meeting, Money in Politics Conference (Copenhagen Business School), International Political Science Association (IPSA), Society for Institutional & Organizational Economics (SIOE), APSA, Stigler Fellows Research Conference (Chicago Booth).

2022: MPSA, NOVAFRICA, Society for Institutional & Organizational Economics (SIOE), APSA, GLD Program at the University of Gothenburg.

2021: MPSA, NEWEPS-16, IHS SuRF Workshop, MIT Latin American Working Group, Penn Africa Symposium, APSA.

2020: APSA.

2019: APSA, Boston-Area Working Group on African Political Economy (B-WGAPE).

2017: MPSA.

2014: Latin American Studies Association.

Invited Talks

2026: PDRI-DevLab (University of Pennsylvania).

2025: Universidad Torcuato Di Tella Business School, Shalem College (Jerusalem), George Mason University Public Choice Seminar.

2024: Parallel Session on Law and Development, Society for Institutional & Organizational Economics (SIOE).

2023: University of Wisconsin-Madison.
2022: King's College London, Duke University.
2020: Hebrew University of Jerusalem, Tel Aviv University, Symposium on the Political Economy of Development Honoring Robert Bates.

Teaching

Instructor (Tel Aviv University)

Power and Prosperity: The Political Economy of Development. Offered Spring 2022/Fall 2022/Spring 2024/Fall 2024/Spring 2025/Spring 2026.
Improving Governance Through Experiments. Offered Spring 2023/Spring 2024/Fall 2024/Spring 2026.
Political Effects of Information Technologies and Social Media. Offered Fall 2022/Fall 2023/Spring 2025.

Teaching Fellow (Harvard University)

GOV 1135: Politics of Development in Africa (Instructor: Pia Raffler), Spring 2021.
GOV 1010: Survey Research Methods (Instructor: Chase Harrison), Fall 2020.
GOV 1740: International Law and Institutions (Instructor: Christoph Mikulaschek), Spring 2020.
GOV 40: International Conflict and Cooperation (Instructor: Stephen Chaudoin), Spring 2019/Spring 2020.
GOV 1008: Introduction to Geographic Information Systems (Instructor: Jill Kelly), Fall 2018.
GOV 1263: Improving Governance in Developing Countries (Instructor: Horacio Larreguy), Spring 2018.
GOV 20: Foundations of Comparative Politics (Instructor: Steve Levitsky), Fall 2017.

Popular Writing

1. Property Rights Provide an Exit from Social Institutions. ProMarket, July 2026 [Link]
2. Family Ties as Corporate Power. ProMarket, July 24 2023 [Link]
3. Kenneth Arrow has died. He changed our view of politics. The Monkey Cage, February 23 2017 [Link]

Professional Service and Membership

Reviewer: Quarterly Journal of Economics (x4), Journal of Political Economy, Review of Economics and Statistics, Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization (x2), American Journal of Political Science, Journal of Politics (x3), British Journal of Political Science, Comparative Political Studies, World Development, World Bank Economic Review, Government and Opposition, European Political Science Review.
Covenor: Tel Aviv University Political Science Speaker Series (2024–2025), Comparative Politics Workshop, Harvard University (2017-18).
Member: American Political Science Association (APSA), Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA), Society for Institutional & Organizational Economics (SIOE), Evidence for Policy Design (EPOD).

Languages and Skills

Languages: English (proficient), French (advanced), German (intermediate), Spanish (native), Hebrew (intermediate).

Programming: R, Stata, ArcGIS.

Fieldwork: Kasaï Central, D.R. Congo (4 months).